Acknowledgements

In 1988 McGeorge Bundy, President Kennedy's former national security assistant, remarked that 'forests have been felled to print the reflections and conclusions of participants, observers and scholars' of the Cuban missile crisis. In the thirty-five years since, deforestation has continued apace as the literature on the subject has grown in scope, perspective, and insight. Debates about the lessons of the crisis have developed in a world where weapons of mass destruction proliferate, armed conflicts persist, and fear of nuclear war grows.

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